EW 6

VERBS TAKING *à quelqu'un*

34. **Dire à quelqu'un de faire quelque chose**

There are a number of verbs that follow the above pattern. You must learn them:

i)	to tell someone to do something	:	**dire** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
ii)	to ask someone to do something	:	**demander** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
iii)	to allow someone to do something	:	**permettre** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
iv)	to forbid someone to do s/thing	:	**défendre** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
v)	to promise someone to do s/thing	:	**promettre** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
vi)	to advise someone to do s/thing	:	**conseiller** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*
vii)	to order someone to do something	:	**ordonner** *A quelqu'un DE faire quelque chose*

Egs.

I will tell the gentleman to wait	:	*Je dirai au monsieur d'attendre*
He allowed his son to go out	:	*Il a permis à son fils de sortir*
We advised everyone to leave	:	*Nous avons conseillé à tout le monde de partir*

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35. **There are a number of verbs, all expressing the idea of `getting something from someone' where `FROM' is translated by `A'**

i)	to buy something from someone	:	*acheter quelque chose A quelqu'un*
ii)	to borrow something from someone	:	*emprunter quelque chose A quelqu'un*
iii)	to hide something from someone	:	*cacher quelque chose A quelqu'un*
iv)	to steal something from someone	:	*voler quelque chose A quelqu'un*
v)	to snatch something from someone	:	*arracher quelque chose A quelqu'un*
vi)	to take something from someone	:	*prendre quelque chose A quelqu'un*

He borrowed a bike from a friend	:	*Il a emprunté un vélo à un ami*
I bought the car from my neighbour	:	*J'ai acheté la voiture à mon voisin*
We stole apples from the farmer	:	*Nous avons volé des pommes au fermier*

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36. **Some other common verbs that are followed by `A quelqu'un'**

i)	to ask someone for something	:	*demander quelque chose A quelqu'un*
ii)	to ask someone a question	:	*poser une question A quelqu'un*
iii)	to answer someone	:	*répondre A quelqu'un*
iv)	to obey someone	:	*obéir A quelqu'un*
v)	to resist someone	:	*résister A quelqu'un / quelque chose*
vi)	to forgive someone	:	*pardonner quelque chose A quelqu'un*
vii)	to please someone	:	*plaire A quelqu'un*

You look like your mother	:	*Tu ressembles à ta mère*
The dog obeyed his master	:	*Le chien a obéi à son maître*
The idea pleased my parents	:	*L'idée a plu à mes parents*

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37. **When you have a PRONOUN (me, you, him,/her, us, you, them) with those verbs that take A + person, the forms are as follows:**

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

me (me); **te** (you); **lui** (him / her); **nous** (us); **vous** (you -plural); **leur** (them)

Remember: these pronouns go before the verb (present, imperfect, future), or before the auxiliary + past participle (passé composé, pluperfect etc)

Remember: that these pronouns will not force an agreement on the past participle because they are INDIRECT

I snatched the knife **from her**	:	*Je **lui** ai arraché le couteau*
We forgave **them**	:	*Nous **leur** avons pardonné*
I asked **her** a question	:	*Je **lui** ai posé une question*

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38. FORMATION OF THE PASSIVE

(ie where the action of the verb is done to the subject not to the object)

This is formed by taking the appropriate tense of *être* and adding the past participle, which will agree in number and gender with the subject.

You must distinguish between STATE and ACTION / EVENT:

STATE	*le soldat **était** blessé* (was wounded)
	*la porte **était** fermée à clef* (was locked)
USE	*Le papier **était** déchiré* (was torn)
IMPERFECT	*La tasse **était** cassée* (was broken)

Here the Imperfect of ETRE + the past participle describe how something was.

ACTION/EVENT	*le soldat **a été** blessé* (was wounded) *par une balle*
ACTION/EVENT	*la porte **a été** fermée à clef* (was locked) *par mon frère*
USE	*Le bâtiment **a été** démoli* (was demolished) *par une bombe*
PASSE COMP	*Ils **ont été** tués* (were killed) *par l'ennemi*

Here the Perfect of ETRE + the past participle records the ACTION of the soldier being wounded and the door being locked etc

HOWEVER . . . if the verb takes ***à quelqu'un*** the passive must be rendered in French using *on* as the subject of an active (ie not a passive) sentence.

This means that all the verbs listed on page 17 and such verbs as *DONNER*, *MONTRER* (to show), *ENVOYER* (to send), *EXPLIQUER* (to explain) fall into this category

we have been told to wait	:	*On nous a dit d'attendre*
We will be allowed to go in	:	*On nous permettra d'entrer*
I had been advised to rest	:	*On m'avait conseillé de me reposer*
We were shown a photo	:	: *On nous a montré une photo*
They were given a permit	:	*On leur a donné un permis*
You will be asked questions	:	*On vous posera des questions*

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

NOTE that there is no past participle agreement because these verbs are followed by "à quelqu'un"

NOTE ALSO

i) <u>The passive of verbs that do not take A + person is also OFTEN AND MOST EASILY rendered by 'ON'</u>

They were threatened	:	*On les a menacés*
We would have been followed	:	*On nous aurait suivis*
They had been warned	:	*On les avait avertis*

ii) <u>The passive of VOIR, CROIRE & SAVOIR is always rendered by `ON'</u>

They were seen leaving	:	*On les a vus partir*
Will it be known if he's coming?	:	*Est-ce qu'on saura s'il vient?*

In both i) and ii) above note that there is a past participle agreement after the preceding direct object.

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW